

PLACER COUNTY SUPERIOR COURT
FRIDAY, CIVIL LAW AND MOTION
DEPARTMENT 1
COMMISSIONER CHRISTINE S. DEHR
TENTATIVE RULINGS FOR JULY 17, 2026 AT 8:30 A.M.

13. S-CV-0054769 KARRI KARASINSKI, KAREN v. GENERAL MOTORS

NOTE: If oral argument is requested in this case, it shall be heard on JULY 17, 2026 AT 1:00 P.M. in DEPARTMENT 1.

Plaintiff's Motion for Attorney's Fees and Costs

In the current request, plaintiff seeks \$19,716.50 in attorneys' fees and \$1,011.08 in costs pursuant to Civil Code section 1794(d). The buyer who prevails under the Song-Beverly Act - colloquially referred to as a "lemon law" case - is statutorily entitled to attorney's fees and costs. (Civil Code section 1794(d); *Pulliam v HNL Automotive Inc.* (2021) 60 Cal.App.5th 396, 405-406.) The prevailing party has the burden of showing the requested fees and costs were reasonably incurred, reasonably necessary, and reasonable in amount. (*Ibid.*) The reasonableness of any attorney's fees award begins with the lodestar calculation, i.e. the actual time spent and the reasonable hourly compensation for the attorney. (*Ketchum v. Moses* (2001) 24 Cal.4th 1122, 1135; *Pulliam, id.* at p. 406.)

The court has carefully considered the number of hours expended by counsel along with the hourly rates for comparable work within Placer County and awards \$17,276.50 broken down as follows:

NAME	RATE	HOURS	TOTAL
Anthony Greco	\$495/hr	21.2	\$10,494.00
Christopher Urner	\$475/hr	7.8	\$ 3,705.00
Jorge Acosta	\$450/hr	3.7	\$ 1,665.00
Timam Khoubian	\$375/hr	1.1	\$ 412.50
Law Clerk "SG"	\$250/hr	4.0	\$ 1,000.00
TOTAL		37.8	\$17,276.50

In sum, the motion is granted. Plaintiff is awarded \$17,276.50 in attorneys' fees and \$1,011.08 in costs.

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